

Seagate diet drives

Seagate unleashes the world's thinnest hard notebook drives, available in 250 GB and 160 GB capacities at spindle speeds of 5,400 rpm. These are only 7 mm high

Nokia and SatNav

SatNav Technologies, pioneers in GPS Navigation in India since 2005 through the brand SatGuide, today launched a FREE version of GPS Navigation Software and Maps for Symbian OS phones by Nokia

moment, secondly this drive gets pretty hot; in fact it registered 65 degrees even in our air-conditioned environs. With this in mind, we're awarding it a joint *Best Performer* award along with Western Digital's 2 TB Black Edition, which was equally impressive, managing to beat even the 10,000 rpm Velociraptor despite a slower 7,200 rpm spindle speed. The *Best Value* award undoubtedly belong to Seagate's 7200.12 1 TB drive — at Rs. 4,600, it's just what the doctor ordered for those who need big storage at a shoestring.

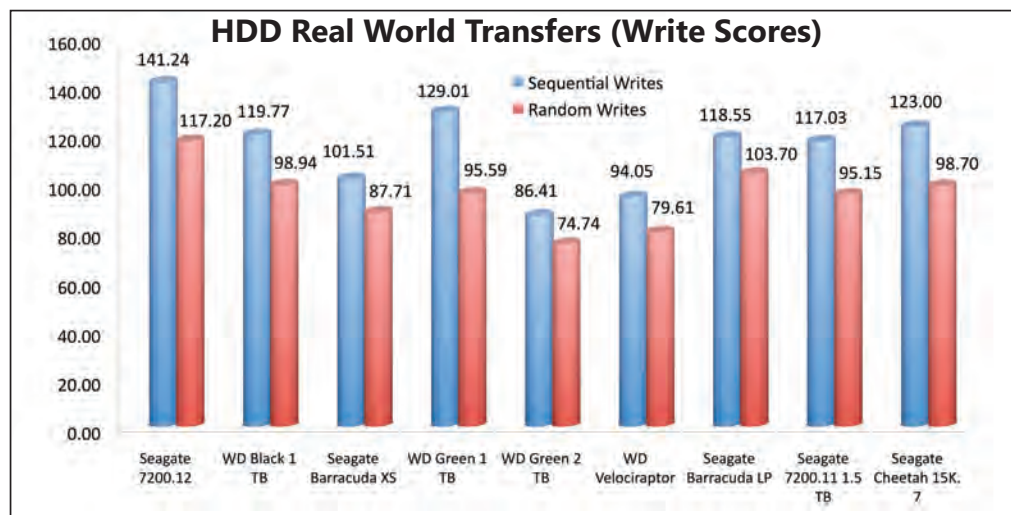
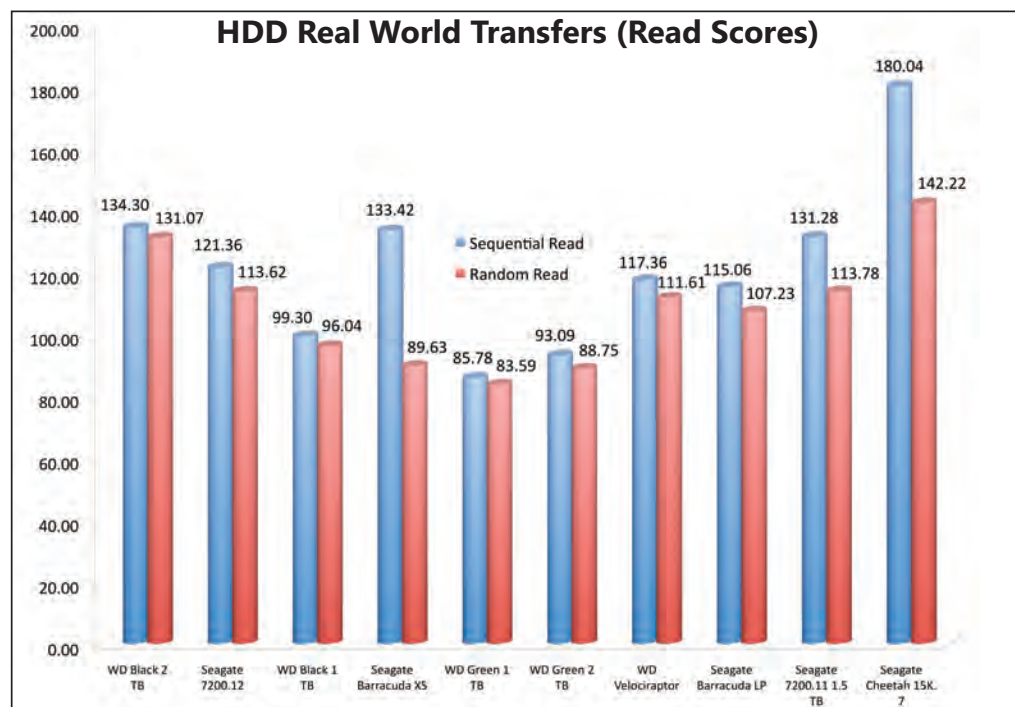
The platter of the matter

Once the test was done, we had a bit of time to think, and contemplate. Sadly, hard drives haven't really become the speed demons we hoped they'd be when SATA 2.0 came along and promised double the

bandwidth. Computing has become faster by miles, just think back five years to the Pentium's, three years back to the first Core 2 Duos and now,

the Core i7s. The same performance delta can be found in the graphics domain, if any of you recall the ATi Radeon X800XT, it was the fastest card of its

time, but will trail the Radeon HD 5870 by at least a 10x factor. The same cannot be said for HDDs, in fact it's been three years and they're still struggling to utilise the bandwidth made available by SATA 2.0. SSDs promise to play saviour to those craving speed and we've seen the fastest SSDs actually come pretty close to the theoretical SATA 2.0 throughput limit, but as we know, they're not exactly affordable. We foresee a period of transition and the next year should see us at its cusp. SATA 3.0 becoming mainstream will be the first step. Hard drives will not be able to take advantage of the improved throughput and this is where flash will step in. Flash manufacturers have promised flash chips rated at 450 MBps for writes and 500 MBps for reads. That's a whole new dimension of speed, and something even 4 x SCSI drives in RAID 0 will not give you. Imagine two such 128 GB SSDs in RAID 0, at a price of under Rs. 20,000! Dare to dream... 



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